Haribabu's links with the LTTE were becoming clearer. A colleague of his had already corroborated that he had seen Haribabu with Subha Sundaram at 'Subha Studio', carrying a large envelope inside which he caught a glimpse of the sandalwood garland. It was a vital piece of evidence, which linked Haribabu with the kurta-pyjama-clad man and the woman who had carried the sandalwood garland. And then the bill of purchase of the garland had also been found at the deceased photographer's house.

Haribabu had turned out to be more than a mere photographer, having close ties with the assassin gang as was evident in his girlfriend Sundari's letters to him. She lived in Villupuram, Madurai, and worked as a nurse. After consulting Kaarthikeyan and Raju, Verma had asked the Tamil Nadu Police to pick up Sundari from Villupuram and bring her to Malligai.

Whatever Haribabu's 'dangerous mission' was, there seemed to be one more 'mission' the assassins could have been involved in. Raju and Kanth had been studying the forensic test results of the clue materials gathered from the blast site and similar reports from the NSG explosives experts. They found similarities between explosives used in Rajiv Gandhi's assassination and some other cases of militant action in the state that largely remained unsolved. Kaarthikeyan had given them a file that contained the earlier cases. Similarities in the modus operandi and groups involved also came to light. The killing of a Tamil leader, K. Padmanabha, and his associates had particularly caught their attention. Raju and Kanth wanted to present their findings to Kaarthikeyan.

Padmanabha was the leader of Tamil rebel group EPRLF, whose objectives were openly criticized by the LTTE, although both were fighting for the liberation of Sri Lankan Tamils. And that case still remained unsolved. Recalling the files acquired from the Tamil Nadu police department, Kanth observed that Padmanabha and other EPRLF leaders were killed in a terrorist attack on 19 June 1990 at the Zachariah Colony apartments in Madras. The killers had used grenades and fired from AK-47 rifles, resulting in a massive bloodbath. The killers had come in a white Ambassador car around 6.30 p.m. After killing Padmanabha and his men,